Michael R. Peterson
Associate Professor & Chair
Department of Computer Science
University of Hawaii at Hilo
200 W. Kawili Street
Hilo, HI 96720
mrp2@hawaii.edu

August 13, 2026

Dimpy Gill, Clark College
Re: CRA NAIRR Pilot Expansion Conference Attendance

Aloha Dr. Gill,

I am writing this letter to confirm your attendance at the 2026 CRA NAIRR Pilot Expansion Conference for Minority Serving Institutions, and to thank you for your attendance and participation. This conference was held August 10-11 in Portland, Oregon and focused on promoting awareness and confidence in AI teaching faculty at MSIs of the educational resources available through NSF's National AI Research Resource pilot program, and to exchange ideas among AI faculty for the improvement of undergraduate AI education across MSIs. This conference was supported by NSF award #2515633 to the University of Hawaii at Hilo and the Computing Research Association (CRA).

The NAIRR pilot allows AI faculty to provide significant computational resources to students without requiring them to pay for expensive tools or compute time. This conference provided information and tutorials that should help attendees such as yourself to utilize supercomputing resources in your own classes with no cost to your institution or students.

The insights and ideas that you and other attendees shared throughout the discussion sessions at this conference will help establish an ongoing community of support for AI teaching faculty at MSIs across the nation. Again, thank you for your attendance and participation!

Sincerely yours,



Michael R. Peterson
PI & Conference Chair, CRA NAIRR Pilot Expansion Conference for MSIs
University of Hawaii at Hilo